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TEAMS IN LIMBO

Amid Illinois high school co-op controversy, an underdog girls lacrosse team plays on

By Andrew Carter | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

One of the enduring quirks, among many, about U-46 girls lacrosse is that it’s a team with no name. Its players are from all over Illinois’ second-largest school district, spread throughout Chicago’s northwest suburbs, and as a co-op team it is without a mascot. They are not the Eagles or Wildcats, or any other animal or army (Knights! Warriors!) ubiquitous in high school athletics. And so when the girls of U-46 break a huddle, forgive the limitation of their rallying cry. “U-46 on three!” their coach, Grace Miller, said countless times over the past few months, during a season that lacked victories but not heart. “One-two-three ... U-46!” Miller and the team yelled countless times over the past few months, through the losses and long practices and abundance of life lessons.

It was a season of learning, played in limbo. Among the state’s largest high schools, the future of co-op sports teams is in doubt. An Illinois High School Association rule change, set to take effect next academic year, will bar co-ops from schools with a combined enrollment of more than 3,500 from competing for state championships. The new rule is meant to stop the formation of so-called super teams, and to promote fairness. An unintended consequence is that it’s likely to lead to fewer opportunities for the teenagers who’ve been a part of co-ops that disband, and choose not to play what would amount to a season’s worth of exhibitions. U-46 girls lacrosse is among more than 100 Illinois co-ops affected by the rule. It also happens to be a particularly poor example of what the rule is attempting to stop. Because while the players of U-46 may be many things — good-spirited, willing to learn, hardened by defeat and defined by perseverance, and showing up game after game, practice after practice — it

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Above: U-46’s Sarah Mozdzen makes her entrance through a bridge of lacrosse sticks at the beginning of a game against Buffalo Grove High School on April 28 in Buffalo Grove. The U-46 girls lacrosse team is a co-op team made up of athletes from several high schools within the district. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

‘BROADVIEW SIX’ CASE

Fallout begins after collapse

US attorney’s office now accused of missteps and a potential cover-up

By Jason Meisner CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The incident on a sunny September morning outside the Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing facility in Broadview may have never been remembered, lost in all the turmoil surrounding Operation Midway Blitz and the resistance that grew out of it. Instead, federal prosecutors went to a grand jury and secured felony conspiracy charges against six protesters who allegedly impeded an immigration agent’s vehicle, elevating the case now known as the “Broadview Six” to a defining moment of the Trump administration’s controversial deportation crackdown. That made the spectacular collapse of the case last week all the more embarrassing for the U.S. attorney’s office, which has now been accused of missteps before the grand jury and a potential cover-up — including the redaction of grand jury materials — that led a federal judge to question whether she can rely on the word of the prosecutors

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INSIDE

Trump says Iran deal is in the final stages

President Donald Trump said on Saturday that a deal including opening the Strait of Hormuz has been “largely negotiated.” Nation & World, Page B5

1 dead in shooting near White House

A person approached a White House security checkpoint and opened fire before being fatally shot by federal officers. Nation & World, Page B5



GREGORY BULL/AP

Celebrating state’s fabulous firsts

Martin Cooper, from Chicago, who as a Motorola executive led the team that built the first mobile cellphone, holds a prototype of that phone at his home on April 4, 2025, in San Diego. On April 3, 1973, he dialed his Chicago-built cellphone prototype from a street in Manhattan. Cooper officially claimed the first-ever cellphone call in history when his rival at AT&T answered. As the nation gears up to celebrate its 250th birthday, we begin a series on what Illinois has uniquely contributed to the nation — and the world. Chicagoland, Page 4

‘These people are fighting for freedom’

Wounded Ukrainian soldiers run the Soldier Field 10 to remember lives lost

By Rebecca Johnson CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Andrii Savenko had to find motivation deep within himself when he learned to walk again. The 41-year-old Ukrainian soldier was severely injured during a mine explosion in 2024 while fighting in the Russia-Ukraine war. He said he needed a prosthetic joint in his leg and plenty of physical therapy to recover. A “champion” mindset is the only way he was able to make it through. Two years later, the progress he’s made is so substantial that he ran a 10K at the Soldier Field 10 on Saturday. He was joined by about 10 Ukrainian service members who traveled to Chicago for Memorial Day weekend. They told the Tribune that they hoped to honor both fallen American and Ukrainian service



members on the holiday as the war in their homeland continues. “It’s a good chance to be together with my comrades as a veteran, active duty wounded

A Ukrainian soldier lights a candle as he holds cards and flowers from students during a visit to St. Nicholas Cathedral School on Friday. About 10 soldiers traveled to Chicago for Memorial Day weekend. JOSH BOLAND/TRIBUNE

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